

Appendix A — Professional Informed Consent

HR SJT — Professional Informed Consent (IRB review copy)

IRB review copy — HR professionals / working professionals. Live interactive page (after deploy):
<https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/professional-consent/>

Informed Consent for Participation in Research

Project Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

Principal Investigator: Dr. Christopher Castille, Management and Marketing

1. Introduction and Purpose

Working professionals, such as HR professionals.

You are invited to participate in a research study comparing how HR professionals and students evaluate workplace tactics in situational judgment scenarios. Your responses will help researchers understand how practitioners apply evidence-based HR practices. Participation is VOLUNTARY. You must be 18 years of age or older.

2. Procedures

If you agree to participate, you will:

Complete a brief demographic questionnaire (including optional BLS race/ethnicity and HR credentials).

Complete the HR Situational Judgment Test (27 scenarios; you may rate the effectiveness of tactics on a 1–5 scale).
Ratings are optional; you may skip any situation.

Receive a feedback report summarizing your ratings.

3. Potential Benefits

Insight into your own HR decision-making through an immediate feedback report.

Learning about evidence-based HR management and situational judgment via the debriefing materials.

Contributing to research on HR education and how professional ratings compare with student ratings.

As a token of appreciation, you may receive an aggregated infographic comparing perspectives (no individuals identified).

There is no monetary compensation.

4. Potential Risks

This study involves minimal risk. Possible risks include:

Mild psychological discomfort if feedback differs from your expectations (feedback is educational and supportive).

Time commitment of approximately 45–60 minutes.

Minimal privacy risk associated with any online data collection; responses are de-identified and stored with a unique code.

Risks are no greater than those encountered in ordinary professional or educational activities. You may skip situations, leave ratings blank, or withdraw at any time without penalty.

5. Your Report and Data Ownership

At the conclusion of the study, you will receive a PDF report of your data, which you may keep. The report will contain a unique identifying code that gives you ownership over your data. If you would prefer to have your data removed from the study, we will honor that request.

6. Time and Compensation

The study takes approximately 45–60 minutes. There is no monetary compensation. Your participation is voluntary and appreciated.

7. Confidentiality

Your privacy is our priority. Your responses will be de-identified and stored with a unique code. No identifiable information will be included in any publications or shared with others.

8. Right to Withdraw

You may withdraw your consent at any time without penalty by closing the browser or contacting the Department of Management and Marketing / Dr. Christopher Castille at christopher.castille@nicholls.edu.

9. Consent

I have been informed about the procedures described above and the potential risks and benefits of the research project. I have had the opportunity to ask questions about the research procedures which have been explained to me. I understand that this project and this consent form have been approved by the Nicholls State University, Human Subjects Institutional Review Board which ensures that research projects follow Nicholls State University policies and procedures and comply with federal guidelines. I have been informed that any modifications of the experimental protocol which might affect my consent or willingness to participate will be provided to me. Finally, I have been provided an opportunity to be informed of the results of this study once it has been completed.

By selecting “I Agree,” you confirm that you are at least 18 years of age, have read this form, and voluntarily agree to participate.

Static IRB review copy. Matches the professional consent text in the PRAMS application. Contact: Dr. Christopher Castille — christopher.castille@nicholls.edu — 985-449-7015.